

Human Writing and Agent Defaults

Max Simchowitz

Why fluent agent prose can still feel choppy or sloppy. Good human writing reflects a writer's judgment about a particular reader. Agent prose often relies on reusable patterns that flatten emphasis, blur semantic relations, and impose an even rhythm.

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Abstract

Agent prose can be difficult to follow even when every sentence is grammatical and the document looks finished. Strong human writing reflects judgments made for a particular reader: it gives ideas unequal weight and states the relations among claims, evidence, and scope. When some of those decisions remain unresolved, agent prose often relies on reusable forms instead. The result may feel choppy when rhythm gives unlike ideas similar emphasis, or sloppy when fluent sentences blur agency and evidential force. Voice also weakens when the prose settles into a portable middle register. Possible explanations include local prediction, missing reader context, and training that rewards visible completeness, but these remain hypotheses. The surface patterns do not establish authorship: people can rely on the same defaults, and agents can produce precise, situated prose. The writing skills developed to correct these problems converge on a common standard: choices of detail, syntax, and emphasis should follow from the argument and the reader's needs.

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1 Situated judgment

The strongest difference between good human prose and common agent prose is not grammatical competence. Both can produce clean sentences. The difference appears in the decisions that organize those sentences: which fact deserves space, which comparison matters, how much confidence the evidence permits, and where the reasoning is complete. A thoughtful human writer makes these decisions for a particular reader. An agent often has to infer them from a prompt that leaves the reader and purpose only partly specified.

This is a comparison of writing defaults, not a claim that every person writes well or every agent writes badly. People produce vague, mechanical prose, and agents can produce precise, situated prose when the task supplies enough context and the revision process is strong. The useful comparison is between passages organized by deliberate judgment about one situation and passages organized by portable patterns that could fit many.

1.1 A particular reader

A writer with a particular reader in view estimates what that person already knows, why they are reading, and which uncertainty will matter to their next inference. Those estimates govern the selection of detail. A reviewer checking a result may need the experimental controls early, while a student learning the mechanism may need conceptual setup before those controls have meaning.

The same judgment governs emphasis. A surprising result receives more space than routine setup, and a limitation appears as soon as it changes the claim. An example remains when it reveals something the abstraction misses. Pace changes with these decisions: conditions may require a longer sentence, while routine connective material can move quickly. A short sentence can mark a conclusion.

1.2 Local fluency

Agent prose can be excellent at the scale of a phrase or sentence while remaining weak at the scale of a paragraph. Each sentence sounds plausible, but the passage may not establish which idea governs the others. Background, evidence, caveats, examples, and conclusions can receive similar weight because familiar completion patterns supply the organization that the prompt did not.

This local fluency explains why agent writing can feel strangely polished and unfinished at the same time. The document may look orderly in every visible respect, yet the reader still has to determine which claim matters and why the listed facts belong together. Its intellectual hierarchy remains unclear.

1.3 Choppiness and sloppiness

Choppiness concerns movement. A passage feels choppy when its sentences do not inherit their pace from the relations among ideas. Several clipped sentences can give routine observations false drama, but a run of medium-length sentences can be equally mechanical when each follows the same grammatical path. Sentence length is only the most visible symptom.

Sloppiness concerns semantic fit. A grammatical sentence can still misstate the relation among its parts. Claims do not “stop,” evidence does not necessarily “explain,” and a section does not literally “know” an answer. Generic emphasis and vague attribution create a similar looseness: tone seems to provide support that the sentence never names.

These defects often reinforce each other. When a writer has not identified the relation among the ideas, the prose tends to list them in separate, similarly shaped units. Once the relation is precise, the writer can choose syntax and cadence that express it.

2 Unequal weight

A human writer assigns available facts unequal weight. Detail is selected according to the reader's problem, then arranged so that evidence, qualification, and explanation remain subordinate to the claim they serve. Common agent prose often begins with coverage and visible completeness, leaving the reader to infer the hierarchy of ideas.

2.1 The reader determines which details matter

The same subject produces different passages for different readers. A collaborator choosing between methods needs the governing tradeoff early. A reviewer may care first about the control that makes the comparison credible. A broad audience may need neither detail until the practical question is clear. Good human prose reveals these assumptions through what it explains and what it leaves compressed.

Agent prose often defaults to details that travel well across contexts: background, definitions, broad benefits, balanced caveats, and a concluding summary. None is inherently wrong. The problem is that their inclusion may follow a familiar document shape rather than a judgment about this reader.

2.2 Catalogs flatten the argument

Common agent default

The report covers architecture, data collection, evaluation metrics, deployment constraints, and future work. Each section offers key insights and important considerations.

Human revision

The report asks whether the system is ready for deployment. Its account of the architecture and data supports that judgment; the evaluation supplies the deciding evidence. Future work concerns the questions that the evidence leaves open.

The agent draft inventories the document and assigns every topic the same status. The human revision supplies a governing question, then gives the remaining material distinct roles. It is more informative even though it names fewer categories, because the reader can see why each one appears.

Lists remain useful when readers need complete membership. Procedures and fixed taxonomies are meant to be scanned, as are option sets. Connected claims depend instead on cause, condition, contrast, or consequence, and prose must make that relation legible.

2.3 Paragraphs reveal a hierarchy of claims

A strong paragraph develops toward a particular inference. Familiar context may lead to a claim and its evidence before the paragraph ends on the consequence or boundary that the evidence supports. Not every paragraph needs all of these moves, and their order changes with the argument. What remains stable is the distinction among their functions.

Agent paragraphs often remain grammatical while losing this hierarchy. A claim, an example, a caveat, and a broad implication arrive in consecutive sentences of similar size. The reader sees four grammatical units but has to reconstruct the dependency among them. Adding bullets or bold labels makes the units easier to scan without resolving that problem.

2.4 Emphasis follows evidence

Good human writing usually earns emphasis through evidence. Agent prose more readily declares importance in advance: events become “pivotal,” designs “underscore” commitments, and methods

“unlock” possibilities. These words create a mood of significance while leaving the basis of the evaluation unclear.

Observable facts give the reader a basis for evaluation that unsupported praise cannot. “The institution opened the archive to the public and placed the catalog online” names two such changes. Calling the archive a transformative milestone adds ceremony but no evidence. If a date, access policy, or catalog size matters, the source must supply it; praise cannot stand in for the missing fact.

3 Semantic precision

Semantic sloppiness often survives grammatical review. A fluent sentence may assign an abstract noun an action it cannot perform, pair a verb with the wrong object, or omit an intermediate needed to state the intended relation. Human prose becomes more exact when the writer notices these mismatches and names the link that the sentence requires.

3.1 The fit between subjects and verbs

Common agent default

A careful reader should understand the evidence behind the claim and where the claim stops.

Human revision

A careful reader should understand the evidence supporting the claim and the conditions that limit its extent.

The first sentence contains two loose relations. Evidence may support or contradict a claim, or remain consistent with it. The claim itself does not travel toward a stopping point. Its validity depends on stated conditions, and its implications need not extend beyond the regime in which it applies.

Changing one verb is not always enough. “The assumptions limit the claim” is still imprecise because it does not identify what becomes narrower. The assumptions may limit the claim’s extent, or the claim may hold only under those assumptions. The missing noun carries part of the meaning.

3.2 Human writers make agency recoverable

Agent prose frequently relies on passive constructions, subjectless fragments, or document personification because each lets the writer continue without identifying who acts. “The results are preserved automatically” may be adequate when the actor is irrelevant. When responsibility matters, “the system preserves the results” gives the reader information the passive version withholds.

Documents can stand for their authors in familiar scholarly shorthand: a paper may argue, report, or show. The shorthand becomes sloppy when it crosses into an action that belongs to a person or analysis. A section can state an answer, but it does not know one. Researchers ask a question; an experimental design tests it.

3.3 Direct verbs expose the mechanism

Abstract wrappers such as “the mechanism behind” or “the role of” name the existence of a relation without stating it. Replacing one of these wrappers with a direct verb requires the writer to identify the relation. One variable may cause, constrain, predict, or merely correlate with another. Those alternatives are not stylistic variants: they make different claims about the evidence.

Simple verbs are often more exact than inflated ones: “is” and “has” state their relations plainly, while “can process” is clearer than “has the ability to process.” Phrases such as “serves as” or “boasts”

add weight without adding specificity. A stronger verb helps only when the evidence supports a more specific action.

3.4 Attribution and uncertainty remain visible

Human research prose distinguishes direct evidence from interpretation. A measurement may show a difference, several experiments may support an explanation, and an observed association may only suggest a mechanism. Changing “suggests” to “demonstrates” does more than tighten the sentence; it strengthens the claim.

Agent prose can also obscure a claim’s source or leave the uncertainty itself unspecified. Vague phrases such as “experts argue” borrow authority from unnamed sources, while stacked hedges such as “could potentially possibly” accumulate caution without locating the uncertainty. Precise prose names the source when one exists and chooses the single evidential verb or condition that matches what is known.

4 Cadence

Cadence is the rhythm produced by the relations among ideas. Writers express causes and conditions differently from contrasts and consequences. Good human writing therefore varies as the thought develops. Agent writing often varies too little or relies on obvious templates for variation.

4.1 Short sentences do not create emphasis by themselves

Common agent default

Then the new model arrived. No warning. No compromise. The old rules were gone.

Human revision

The new model changed the comparison because its design did not rely on the assumptions built into the earlier systems.

The clipped version gives every phrase dramatic closure, including details that have not earned it. The revision joins the event to its explanation, so the causal relation determines the pace. A short sentence would still be appropriate if the paragraph had reached a conclusion worth isolating.

4.2 Uniform medium sentences can be equally choppy

Common agent default

The study evaluates the controller in simulation. The study measures robustness under observation noise. The study compares performance across three tasks. The study reports consistent gains.

Human revision

The study evaluates the controller in simulation and measures its robustness to observation noise across three tasks. It reports consistent gains in each task.

Nothing in the first passage is fragmentary, yet the repeated subject and sentence length make the prose advance in separate, equally weighted steps. The revision combines aspects of the same evaluation, then states the cross-task result in a separate sentence. Its change in pace follows the relation among the claims rather than a schedule of long and short sentences.

4.3 Openings and endings distribute stress

Readers use the opening of a sentence to connect with established context and its syntactic closure to identify what deserves emphasis. A subject placed near its verb is easier to track; an important result placed near the end of the sentence receives natural stress. These are tendencies rather than a template, but they explain why rearrangement can improve cadence without changing sentence length.

Mechanical variation has the opposite effect. Fronting a prepositional phrase only to avoid another sentence beginning with “The” moves emphasis without a reason. Alternating long and short sentences by count produces variety on the page while leaving the spoken rhythm artificial.

4.4 Contrast needs more than one syntax

Research writing depends on contrast when a result must be interpreted against an alternative or kept within its proper scope. The agent-like tendency lies in repeating the same frame after the scientific relation changes: “not X but Y,” “treats X as Y, not Z,” and “rather than merely X, Y.”

A human writer can state the supported positive claim first. The comparator may appear in a separate clause, or the evidence itself may establish the difference. A causal contrast and a scope limitation need not sound alike. Repetition remains useful when a fixed taxonomy demands parallel form; outside that setting, it makes distinct ideas sound interchangeable.

4.5 Cadence extends across paragraphs

A paragraph break does not reset the rhythm. Several list-shaped sentences remain monotonous when split into separate paragraphs, and a short heading followed by a one-line paragraph can continue the same staccato rhythm. Human cadence is therefore a passage-level property. Sentences pick up context from one another, and paragraph boundaries mark changes in the reasoning rather than opportunities to restart the same pattern.

5 Visible organization

Headings, lists, summaries, and balanced sections make a document look finished. They are also easy for an evaluator to recognize. Agent prose often uses these signals before the relations among its claims are clear. The layout can then give equal weight to ideas that play very different roles.

5.1 Headings can expose or conceal the argument

A useful heading marks a real change in the reader’s task. Tiny sections and headings that merely restate their first sentence create navigation without reducing uncertainty. Bold label-and-colon bullets have a similar effect: connected claims begin to resemble independent interface fields.

Human writers also use headings and bullets, but the form follows the reading task. A fixed procedure benefits from visible steps; a reference taxonomy benefits from parallel entries. An explanation usually needs connected prose because the relation among its claims matters more than their count.

5.2 Abstracts show the difference sharply

Common agent default

This article presents a comprehensive framework for human and agent writing. It discusses reader models, examines sentence structure, and explores cadence. It also provides a taxonomy and directions for future work.

Human revision

Agent prose can remain fluent while flattening emphasis and loosening semantic relations. Comparing passages shows that its choppiness and sloppiness often arise when reusable patterns replace judgment about a particular reader.

The first abstract tours the document. Its sentences are accurate as an inventory, but a reader finishes without knowing the article's answer. The human revision uses the same space to establish the phenomenon and explain it through a direct comparison.

This difference matters because an abstract is a person's first encounter with the argument. A strong abstract does not give every section equal space. It selects the problem, answer, decisive evidence, and claim boundary needed to understand the work without reading the paper.

5.3 Paragraphs often end by convention

An agent-generated paragraph may append a slogan, broad implication, or summary because the local form suggests that a conclusion is due. The sentence creates tonal completion even when the reasoning ended one line earlier.

Common agent default

The method improves accuracy only when labeled examples are available. Together, these findings provide valuable insight and open exciting directions for future research.

Human revision

The method improves accuracy only when labeled examples are available.

The limitation is the natural ending because it determines the extent of the result. The generic final sentence shifts attention from that boundary to unsupported uplift. A human paragraph may also end on an unresolved tension, a concrete fact, or a transition that the next paragraph genuinely needs. It need not sound conclusive merely because it ends.

5.4 Formatting cannot supply hierarchy

Mechanical boldface, title case everywhere, decorative icons, and dense bullet lists can accompany agent writing, but none identifies its author. They become problems when the visual hierarchy disagrees with the argument. Typography can help a reader locate structure; it cannot create the structure that the prose has not established.

6 Voice

Voice is often mistaken for ornament or conspicuous personality. In strong human writing, voice begins earlier. It appears in what the writer notices, which tension remains unresolved, and how much space a particular exception receives. These choices show a mind attending to a subject rather than a style applied uniformly to content.

6.1 Specific details constrain generic prose

Names, measurements, dates, odd quotations, and concrete observations narrow the range of plausible continuations. They also give the reader something to verify. Agent prose often replaces them with broad claims of significance; an overzealous humanizer can repeat the loss by replacing every irregularity with smooth, generic language.

Specificity does not license invention. A detail belongs because it comes from the writer's experience or the available evidence, not because vivid prose sounds more human. The same constraint applies to every factual and technical claim.

6.2 Human judgment can remain mixed

People do not always arrive at balanced conclusions. A writer may consider a policy broadly useful and still distrust one consequence; a study may show a strong result in one regime alongside an unexplained failure in another. When the evidence does not settle the tension, preserving it is more accurate than extracting a clean lesson.

Agent prose often resolves this discomfort through symmetry. An optimistic final paragraph softens criticism, uncertainty becomes a balanced caveat, and an unexplained observation becomes a broad takeaway. The resulting passage sounds complete because its tone is settled, not because its evidence is.

6.3 Borrowed registers conceal the writer

The generic agent register draws from several recognizable sources. Corporate language turns ideas into objects of alignment, impact, or ownership. LinkedIn cadence produces one-line lessons and motivational closure. Reddit supplies fake-casual throat clearing; GitHub contributes terse inventory prose and diff narration. Chat adds praise for the question and offers to continue.

Common agent default

This framework empowers writers to unlock clear, impactful communication and drive meaningful engagement.

Human revision

The framework separates errors of evidence from errors of cadence because the two require different revisions.

The human sentence sounds more academic without relying on formality for its own sake. It names the distinction and explains why it matters. The agent sentence could describe almost any writing tool, which is precisely why it reveals so little about this one.

6.4 Genre shapes the expression of voice

An essay can support an openly personal voice. Technical or legal prose may require neutrality, yet neutrality need not become generic. A careful academic still reveals priorities through exact comparisons and calibrated uncertainty. The decision to pause over one exception also carries voice.

Deliberate irregularity belongs to this account of voice. A parenthetical aside, abrupt transition, or distinctive word can carry information when the reader can infer its purpose. Random variation does not become human merely by being uneven. The difference is whether the choice reflects a judgment the writer can explain.

7 Why defaults recur

Surface patterns alone do not reveal their causes. The explanations below are hypotheses about pressures that may favor portable language and local regularity. They are useful because they generate different predictions, not because the prose alone proves any one of them.

7.1 Local prediction rewards local plausibility

During pretraining, a language model learns to predict each next token from the preceding context. Later training changes its behavior, but familiar phrases and locally smooth continuations may remain attractive even when the paragraph requires a less common structure. A stock transition can therefore fit its immediate sentence while weakening the larger argument.

This account helps explain two apparently opposite defaults. Repeated formulas preserve familiar shapes, while synonym cycling avoids lexical repetition by changing the name of a stable object. In both cases, a locally plausible choice forces the reader to recover the paragraph-level relation.

7.2 Missing reader context leaves priorities unclear

A prompt can name a task without identifying the person who will use the answer. In that setting, the model has little basis for deciding which background to omit or which consequence matters. It may not know whether an objection deserves space. Generic helpfulness then fills the gap with broad explanation and visible signposting; the answer tends toward balanced coverage and portable management language.

The reader hypothesis predicts that specificity should improve the selection of detail, not merely the tone. A response written for a reviewer with a pending decision ought to emphasize different evidence from one written for a student encountering the mechanism for the first time.

7.3 Training may reward visible completeness

Instruction tuning and preference optimization may favor features that evaluators readily recognize as helpful. Headings, long lists, summaries, caveats, and offers to continue make a chat response look thorough. Transferred into a finished article, the same habits can interrupt continuity or append material after the argument has ended.

Mixed training data may also favor a middle register acceptable across many genres. Code documentation and issue trackers contribute terse inventory prose, while business writing supplies a managerial register. Essays and reference works add other conventions. Without a strong cue about voice and genre, their most portable features can combine into prose that is competent but weakly situated.

The three pressures can reinforce one another. Local prediction supplies the familiar phrase, post-training rewards its recognizable helpfulness, and missing reader context gives the model no reason to remove it. The resulting passage can satisfy the conventions of a helpful answer without resolving the problem that brought the reader to it.

8 A common standard across the writing skills

The skills designed to humanize agent writing address recurring agent defaults from different directions, but their diagnoses converge. None defines human prose as a collection of preferred words. Together, they describe writing in which the reader, evidence, semantic relation, and rhythm constrain one another.

8.1 Humanizer identifies reusable surface defaults

Humanizer provides the broadest catalog. It detects inflated significance, promotional language, vague attribution, chat residue, repeated contrast frames, loose catalogs, mismatched relations, and mechanical endings. The patterns differ, but many have the same effect: a familiar form replaces a decision specific to the passage.

The catalog is diagnostic rather than forensic. Human writers can produce any of these patterns, and agents can avoid them. Their value lies in the reading effects they expose. Some hide agency or inflate an evaluation; others flatten priority or detach rhythm from meaning.

8.2 Usage, cadence, and paragraph structure

Better-usage operates inside the sentence. It tests whether the subject can perform its verb, whether the object fits that verb, and whether the sentence has omitted an intermediate such as a claim's extent or a theorem's consequences. This is the most direct answer to semantic sloppiness.

Writing-cadence examines rhythm across a passage. At that scale, staccato runs, uniform lengths, repeated openings, and weak endings become visible. Its standard is purposeful emphasis: writers join or divide sentences so the prose accelerates and pauses with the argument.

The non-autoregressive writing pass begins only after the draft exists as a whole. It rereads the title, subtitle, headings, and paragraph openings against the finished argument, then places each paragraph's last sentence beside the next opening. This wider view catches a heading or topic sentence that promises a weaker claim than the passage develops, along with locally fluent transitions that misstate the relation between paragraphs.

8.3 The reader's problem in academic prose and abstracts

Academic-voice describes a writer who is careful and precise, with a strong interest in being understood. It rejects corporate and social-media registers, whose recognizable postures often replace exact claims. Paper-writing adds discipline about claims and evidence; its sentence guidance keeps the main subject and verb visible and avoids packing several inferences into one line.

Abstract-writing exposes the difference between coverage and understanding. An agent abstract often summarizes sections or inventories contributions. A strong human abstract gives the reader enough to grasp the problem, central answer, decisive evidence, and conditions that determine the claim's extent. Its ending completes the inference rather than announcing future work or repeating the contribution.

8.4 General-writing preserves the writer during revision

General-writing combines broad cleanup with comparison against the source. That comparison matters because fluent revision can erase the very features that made the draft human: a specific fact, calibrated uncertainty, an abrupt but purposeful transition, or an unusual cadence the writer can defend. Humanization succeeds only when the writer remains recognizable.

Good human writing is distinguished by choices that follow from the argument and the needs of a particular reader; neither messiness nor polish establishes that standard. A reader can tell why a fact appears, why one sentence is long and another short, why a qualification interrupts, and why the paragraph ends where it does. Agent prose feels choppy or sloppy when it falls back on reusable forms without enough information about the argument or reader.

A A comparison map

The table condenses the comparison developed in the article. Its right column describes common agent defaults, not necessary properties of generated text. The same patterns occur in human drafts, which is why the comparison belongs at the level of passages rather than authors.

Dimension	Strong human prose	Common agent default
Reader model	Chooses background and examples for what a particular reader knows and needs.	Falls back on portable explanation and generic helpfulness when the reader is unspecified.
Priority	Gives more space to the central claim and deciding evidence than to routine background.	Distributes equal visual and rhythmic weight across background, evidence, caveats, and implications.
Semantic fit	Matches subjects with actions they can perform and names missing links such as extent, applicability, or consequence.	Produces grammatical but loose combinations such as claims that “stop” or sections that “know.”
Evidence	Names sources and distinguishes direct results from interpretation or open questions.	Relies on vague attribution, inflated significance, or evidential verbs stronger than the available support.
Continuity	Connects sentences through cause, condition, contrast, and consequence.	Places related ideas in separate, similarly shaped sentences or list items and leaves the reader to recover the dependency.
Cadence	Varies sentence length and structure because ideas have different roles and weights.	Stacks clipped sentences for drama or repeats medium-length constructions with the same opening and closure.
Contrast	Chooses syntax according to the comparator, negative result, mechanism, or claim boundary at issue.	Repeats frames such as “not X but Y” or “treats X as Y, not Z” after the underlying relation changes.
Voice	Reveals judgment through selected details, calibrated uncertainty, and deliberate irregularity.	Defaults to a portable middle register assembled from corporate, social-media, documentation, and chat conventions.
Structure	Uses headings and lists when readers need to navigate a real change of question or scan a complete set.	Uses visible organization to make a document look complete before the dependencies among its ideas are clear.
Abstract	Explains the problem, central answer, decisive evidence, and claim boundary.	Tours the sections, inventories contributions, or gives every component equal space.
Ending	Ends on the supported consequence, limitation, unresolved tension, or concrete fact at which the reasoning arrives.	Appends a summary, slogan, broad implication, or optimistic future because the form appears to require closure.

B Terms and limits of the comparison

B.1 Human and agent are evaluative labels

In this article, *human writing* refers to the positive standard distilled from the writing skills: situated, precise prose whose details and rhythm reflect a writer’s judgment. It does not describe everything people write. *Agent writing* refers to recurrent defaults that appear when generated prose lacks enough

information about reader, evidence, voice, or purpose. It does not describe everything an agent can produce.

This usage keeps the comparison useful without turning style into a detector. A person can produce an agent-like passage by relying on formulas, and a model can produce human-quality prose when it has strong context, evidence, and revision. Authorship requires independent evidence such as drafts, version history, or production records.

B.2 Choppiness is a passage-level rhythm

Choppiness includes staccato fragments, but it is not reducible to short sentences. Repeated medium-length sentences can produce the same effect when they begin alike, carry one clause each, and close with equal stress. A paragraph break does not remove the pattern.

The relevant test is whether the rhythm reflects the argument. A short sentence can isolate a real conclusion. A long sentence can hold a result and its essential condition. Either becomes difficult when its form gives the wrong idea too much weight or conceals the relation the reader needs.

B.3 Sloppiness is semantic before it is grammatical

The word *sloppy* names imprecision that survives grammatical review. A sentence may assign its subject an impossible action or pair a verb with the wrong object. An abstract noun may also conceal the actor. Evidential sloppiness has a related structure: support becomes proof, or an attribution goes unnamed. Several hedges may still fail to identify the actual uncertainty.

Better-usage treats these defects as failures of semantic compatibility. Humanizer extends the same concern to rhetorical relations: generic significance, loose catalogs, and corporate shorthand sound complete while leaving the relevant evidence or reader need unspecified.

B.4 Surface patterns do not prove authorship

No single word, punctuation mark, or sentence length establishes that a passage is agent-generated. Professional editing can explain regular grammar; templates can explain visible structure; a field's shared vocabulary can explain repeated terms. Quotations and examples retain the language of their source.

The comparison becomes strongest when several patterns converge on one reading effect. Repeated syntax, equal-weight lists, vague attribution, and a generic ending may together show that a passage lacks hierarchy. That diagnosis supports revision even when the author is known.

C Sources and acknowledgments

This article synthesizes Humanizer version 2.15.0 with focused skills for general revision, semantic usage, cadence, academic voice, research abstracts, paper writing, and whole-draft transitions from the [writing-skills](#) repository.

Humanizer builds on Siqi Chen's [humanizer](#), whose pattern catalog draws from Wikipedia's [Signs of AI writing](#). The general-writing framework builds on Peter Yang's [no-ai-slop](#). Both upstream projects are distributed under the MIT License, and their license notices remain with the corresponding skills.

The cadence discussion draws on [Purdue OWL's account of sentence variety](#) and [Gopen and Swan's analysis of reader expectations in scientific prose](#). The discussion of research voice and abstracts also uses the local conventions distilled from the author's example papers in the paper-writing and abstract-writing skills.

The causal accounts in [Section 7](#) are hypotheses proposed in this article. They do not represent positions taken by the upstream projects.